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Decoding the consumer

Peeled away to the core of what drives buying decisions Page 4

WELL BEING

DO SUPPLEMENTS REALLY ADD UP?

Dietary supplements & nutraceuticals are increasingly lining the shelves of our local stores. But are they as unassuming and healthy as they claim to be? Page 9

FE LINES

Staying cool on the go

How wearable cooling devices are changing the definition of summer comfort Page 8

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LEISURE

WELCOMING GLOBALART

Rise in international exhibitions, artwork loans involving India Page 7

Here's to more Asian Gains!

Amul Go for gold

Indian basketball all set to have its IPL moment

● League to be an entertainment product, says CEO

55 mn

people play basketball in India

Early 2027

Inaugural season of the India Basketball League

100 mn

fans engage with basketball in India

6

No. of participating cities announced so far

Format

5x5 & 3x3 competitions for men and women

Developer

Basketball Federation of India and ACG Sports

"IPL succeeded because it built something that fits cricket, fits India. It's a new moment. That's exactly what we are trying to do with basketball"

— JAKE LUSH MCCORM, CEO, IBL

value, embracing innovation, and investing heavily in talent development. These principles are not as much about cricket as they are to cricket," he added.

— The rising star of the country's first professional basketball league — being developed by the Basketball Federation of India (BFI) and sports management company ACG Sports — is significant. Today, basketball is played by over 55 million people in India, and more than 100 million fans engage with the sport. IBL is scheduled to launch its inaugural season in early 2027.

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WHAT'S INSIDE

■ SPOTLIGHT, P5

A new white revolution

The Indian dairy industry is no longer just about milk; it is becoming a broader consumer story

■ LIVING, P6

No planning needed

A holiday that you can choose based on mood, interest, community or even gender, all curated to the last detail

RUSSIA & IRAN SANCTIONS ACT SIGNED

India faces hefty tariff risk under Trump's new law

● Can push for waivers, but firm on energy security

30 days

Law to take effect within

US TR to identify countries to be targeted, recommend tariff rates

180 days

Countries to get to reduce Russian energy over-haunt on negotiate with US

But Trump can shorten period, impose tariffs sooner

Govt to monetise land, buildings worth ₹5,000 cr

FE BUREAU

New Delhi, September 19

THE NATIONAL LAND Monetisation Corporation (NLMC) will monetise surplus land and building assets valued at more than ₹5,000 crore as the state-run corporation steps up efforts to unlock value from underutilised public assets.

The proposals were discussed at the 21st meeting of NLMC's Board of Directors held on Friday, which reviewed the corporation's asset monetisation programme, financial performance and institutional initiatives.

UNLOCKING VALUE

NLMC aims to unlock value from underutilised public assets

● Reveal

● To ensure

Keyword match: "cricket"

...ertainment development. Those principles

apply just as much to basketball as they do to cricket," he added.

basketball in India India Basketball League

first professional basketball KUNAL DOLEY league-

being developed by New Delhi, September 19

"IPL succeeded because it built No. of participating cities

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Niran Kumar
Senior Officer

Meeting
Date: 24/09/2026
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At: 2023

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Niran Kumar
Senior Officer
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to be the end of the world, he said. Huang believes the artificial intelligence (AI) industry needs to push ahead with development keeping safety of products in mind.

"We should go as fast as we can irrespective of anybody else... We're going to go as fast as we can, but we would never ever, and never should, ship products before they're ready, deliver products that are unsafe. And

but everybody's expecting us to succeed and help America be as prosperous as possible," he said.

Threats of an extinction level event being set off by AI has become a raging debate in the industry after Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei advocated for slowing down the pace of AI model development saying that if unchecked this could outrun human ability to control such systems.

sedans to make a comeback," it has been a trend that sales marginally rise for a few months with each new launch/ facelift of a sedan — as we saw with the all-new Hyundai Verna wayback in 2023, and before that in 2022 when Skoda introduced the Slavia and Volkswagen launched the Virtus, but then they eventually taper," Vangaal said. "The market has wholly shifted to SUVs, and midsize sedans, in

total sedan sales between January and August, Maruti Suzuki's Dzire has sold 1,68,413 units, and is on track to become India's single largest-selling PV in 2026. But remove the Dzire, and the rest of the sedan market has collapsed. Among entry-level sedans, the Hyundai Aura has sold 49,517 units, the Honda Amaze 26,676 units, and the Tata Tigor 7,504 units. Among midsize sedans, the Virtus has

fundamental shift in consumer preference towards high driving positions, commanding road presence, and high ground clearance. Entry-level buyers who once upgraded to midsize sedans are now jumping straight to compact crossover SUVs — a shift that claimed its first major casualty last year when Maruti Suzuki discontinued the Ciaz after its FY26 sales plummeted to just 1,980 units.

Indian basketball all set to have its IPL moment



Six participating cities have already been announced. ACG Sports will own and operate all the six teams for the first couple of years to keep quality and standards consistent.

IBL is aiming to deliver an aspirational, premium and highly entertaining sports experience from its very first season. On the court, fans can expect a compelling mix of India's top talent and international stars. Off the court, the focus will be on high-quality production, engaging storytelling and digital-first fan experiences. "Whether you are in the arena or following the action through streaming or broadcast, IBL will be exciting, accessible, and really premium," said McCrum.

According to McCrum, what excites him most, however, is the role fans will play in building this league. "From helping determine which cities take the court in Season 1 to influencing team identities and contributing in community initiatives, this isn't a league being handed to fans fully formed. It's a league being built with them, from the very beginning," he added.

In terms of sponsorships and commercial partnerships, discussions are progressing strongly. "At this stage, what I can say is that we are seeing strong interest from brands that understand the huge potential of basketball and youth culture in India. Announcements are coming soon," McCrum said.

According to him, if a league is going to be sustainable, it must invest in the product. "We have done exactly this by investing in the foundation first — a state-of-the-art high-performance centre (in Bengaluru) providing elite training and world-class infrastructure to the best basketball talent in India," he said. "The players will have been trained for over 15 months before the first season of IBL tips off. This gives us a much stronger platform to build from and the confidence to deliver a high-quality league," he added.

The IBL comes at a time when many non-cricketing leagues have followed in the footsteps of the IPL's business model and success.

The Pro Kabaddi League (PKL), which premiered in 2014, for instance, is now the second most watched sports league in India after the IPL. Other sporting leagues

creating waves include Indian Super League (ISL), Women's Premier League (WPL), Prime Volleyball League (PVL), Ultimate Kho Kho (UKK), Ultimate Table Tennis (UTT), Global Chess League (GCL) and Pro Panja League (PPL).

Just to get a sense of their popularity — the inaugural season of PKL was seen by 435 million viewers, second only to the 2014 IPL's 552 million, while the first season final between Jaipur Pink Panthers and U-Mumba was watched by 86.4 million.

Similarly, the ISL — the sole recognised top-tier football league in India — had 157 million unique viewers in 2024-25. The inaugural edition of Women's Premier League, meanwhile, in 2023 hit 50.8 million viewers in the first week and 67.8 million TV reach in the first 14 matches; and in 2024 hit ~103 million TV reach in the first ~15 games, as per a 2025 KPMG-Sportstar report.

In October, India is hosting the World Armwrestling Championship, which will give

the country's Pro Panja League (PPL) a shot in the arm. Started by actor-couple Parvin Dabbas and Preeti Jhangiani, PPL has had two seasons so far — New Delhi in 2023, and Gwalior in 2025. McCrum clarifies at the outset that their ambition is not to copy the IPL, but to "build the best basketball league for India and the broader Indian diaspora".

"What excites me is that basketball is already a truly global sport that resonates with young audiences, is digital-first, culturally relevant and fast-paced. These characteristics align exceptionally well with India's demographics. If we consistently deliver a great product, create stars and engage fans authentically, there's absolutely no reason why IBL can't become one of India's biggest sporting properties over time," he added. According to McCrum, IBL didn't succeed because it copied another league — it succeeded because it built something that fits cricket, fits India, fits the moment. "That's exactly what we are trying to do with basketball," he added.

Keyword match: "cricket"

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Full Article Text (English)

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WE ALWAYS LIKE OF 'VALUE' R MONEY AND THIS IS WHAT MARKETERS LAY ON WHEN PEEPLING TO THE MASSES

Conscious behaviour, preconscious emotions and subconscious motivations are some of the factors that drive consumption, as per the author

Decoding the CONSUMER

Peeling away to the core of what drives buying decisions

are a little difficult to assimilate. He talks of 'cast', 'trust', 'enjoyment' and 'nostalgia' which have evolved from different legacies through which we have been through. Trust is now moving from faith to fact, which is a very important point made by Subramanian as we accept nothing at face value. Nostalgia is more deeply concerned with what we consume, which can be organic food or even peace of mind. Enjoyment has become more personal today as we move away from the spotlight of community enjoyment which was manifested in festivals or even watching TV together.

The subconscious motivations are driven by psychology, and the three drivers are aspiration, assertion and commitment. These can also be seen in consumption patterns as we move out of our comfort zone and become more individualistic, from being servile there is a movement to being assertive. This can be seen in our cricketers who have now found confidence as evident in the swag and arrogance that can be seen in their body language and play.

The author's focus is more on the urban youth, whom he terms 'tribesmen'. But this section is stacked through different eras starting from post-independence to more recent times and how this group looked at consumption. The time chosen periods are ones of scarcity post-independence which got transformed into state-driven development in the 70s and 80s to the relaxation in the next two decades, and digitalisation that we see today.

While the author explains each of these 12 factors in separate chapters with several examples to make it relatable for the reader, he admits that these are not what we may be following in a conscious manner all the time. As his output is what goes into as inputs in devising any brand strategy, this book is a must read for anyone in the B2C business. Putting the pieces together for any successful product can mean borrowing from what Subramanian has put forward as 12 peels for which the boxes can be tick marked.

Madan Sabnavis is chief economist, Bank of Baroda

argues that debate became the "proof of progress", therefore, failing to demand change, execution and institutional stamina". In Kerala, the moral authority, it adds, was reduced to a "scandal economy" and "reaction republic". And the Kerala Model, "once a dynamic framework, hardened into doctrine".

The book spends long pages in articulating missed opportunities in harnessing other strengths of the state, like its rich tradition, diversity and freedom society

Small, deliberate changes can alter how we feel, think and perform, proposes Protocol. Andrew Rubberman explains the science behind each protocol and, importantly, how to adapt it to individual needs rather than treating health as a one-size-fits-all prescription. From morning light and sleep to stress regulation, the book addresses the ordinary problems that shape extraordinary amounts of our lives.

PALESTINE: A SHORT HISTORY Rashid I Khalidi Hachette Pp 256, ₹499

Palestine offers a powerful introduction to Palestinian history through a century of conflict and resistance. Blending incisive research with his own family memories, celebrated scholar Rashid Khalidi traces Palestine's story from the British occupation to Israel's ongoing colonial war. Powerfully explaining the history behind the world's most urgent — and misunderstood — conflict, Rashidi explores why Israel has long fought against Palestine.

FORGOTTEN FEMINISMS Sindhu Rajasekaran Aleph Book Company Pp 320, ₹899

In most historical accounts, Indian women have figured as footnotes to the history of 'great' men, and have usually been cast as victims of the patriarchy. *Forgotten Feminisms* challenges this reading of history. Rajasekaran argues that, historically, Indian women weren't helpless victims in need of saviours — our foremothers, across the socio-economic spectrum, gave fierce battle to both the Brahmanic patriarchy and British colonialism.

POLICIES THAT SHAPED MODERN INDIA Madan Sabnavis Rupa Publications Pp 208, ₹695

Policies That Shaped Modern India delves into the experimental nature of policy planning, engaging in an

Chasing a mirage

Confronting Kerala's challenges might need much more than a self-help book

Keyword match: "cricket"

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Rashidi explores why Israel has dently various factors...

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RINGSIDE VIEW
TUSHAR BHADURI

MAYBE, THE BOARD OF CONTROL FOR CRICKET IN INDIA (BCCI) does have a plan. Maybe, the phone chos know covering up embarrassing moments.

—The evening event's cricket trophy, which made a lot of noise in the days after the tournament, slowly disappeared from the headlines, making a return only when the team followed suit in its bid to win the Asian Cup trophy ahead of the final of the Asia Cup 2026 final.

The trophy, which was presented to the captain of the Indian team, was a replay of the men's trophy when India won the Asia Cup in 2013. The trophy was a replay of the men's trophy when India won the Asia Cup in 2013. The trophy was a replay of the men's trophy when India won the Asia Cup in 2013.

Official explanation
BCCI secretary Desai said the decision to not show the trophy was a result of a decision taken by the board. He said the board had decided to not show the trophy because it was a replay of the men's trophy when India won the Asia Cup in 2013.

What happens next
At the recent Hockey World Cup, India and Pakistan played a high-scoring match with the former coming out 5-1 winners. The game was devoid of any drama of the unsavory kind. In the Asia Cup, the Indian team played a high-scoring match with the former coming out 5-1 winners. The game was devoid of any drama of the unsavory kind.

India Women's captain Harmanpreet Kaur and Sri Lanka Women's captain Chamari Athapaththu pose with the trophy ahead of the Women's Asia Cup 2026 final.

The Asia Cup final was a replay of the men's trophy when India won the Asia Cup in 2013.

India refused to accept the trophy from Pak's Mohsin Naqvi. Will they wait till a new ACC chief takes over?

Uncredited visuals go viral
BCCI's summit 2026 was perhaps the first major international conference in Delhi where the Ministry of External Affairs cut the Information and Broadcasting Ministry out of the loop. Normally at such events, the I&B department handles duties such as liaising with domestic and international media, preparing background material and briefs, local facilitation for visitors and covering up embarrassing moments. Without the seasoned hand of the I&B to smooth wrinkles, some of the unedited optics at the conference went viral. The decision to transport all central ministers and chief ministers from Parliament House to the Bharat Mandapam in two buses may have been taken elsewhere — but senior leaders such as Amit Shah, J P Nadda and Yogi Adityanath are unlikely to have been surrounded with media showing them held together in a bus. Only Prime Minister Modi had a separate cavalcade to reach the Mandapam, along with most of the foreign heads of state. Some felt the bus journey was unnecessary. Considering the media control from Parliament House to the Mandapam was, in any case, fairly empty and fully secure, a few extra ministerial cars on this route would have made little difference. Another awkward video widely shared, possibly exaggerated by AI, was of National Security Adviser Ajit Doval manning a cashew sitting to the rear of Russian President Vladimir Putin and the MIA's official spokesperson. Kandhar Jalwal nibbling nuts continuously, though seated right behind Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, in the full glare of the TV cameras. Finally, the MIA's chief of a young woman ending every statement presented in the podium gift bag to journalists, from toothbrush to notebook, was cringe-worthy. The publicity should have focused on the gains of the Delhi declaration, not mementos, on the misguided notion they would attract young viewership.

Diplomatic concessions
Since 2012, the MIA has followed a policy of disallowing meetings between visiting foreign heads and opposition political leaders or activists, under the order of security agencies. But the BCCI, the government understood that to further its foreign relations' objectives, exceptions had to be made. Malaysian Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim was permitted to breakfast with Rahul Gandhi and Piyush Gada, and he tweeted their interaction, describing Rahul as a good friend who helped him in current affairs and foreign issues. Ibrahim is grateful to the Congress because when he was in jail in his homeland, then PM Manmohan Singh offered to facilitate the education of his son abroad. An exception was also made for Ibrahim, a devout Muslim, to call on Islamic cleric in Kerala. Meanwhile, at the request of Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, controversial Iranian Conference leader Mirwaiz Rahman, who has frequently been detained in Kashmir, was permitted to attend a diplomatic reception in Delhi hosted by the Iranian embassy for its president. Later, Mirwaiz had a long conversation with Iranian foreign minister Abbas Araghchi.

Keeping media guessing
Ever since BJP President Nitin Gadkari announced his team, the media and people who claim to be in the know — if that is indeed possible in this closed-door regime — have speculated that a ministerial reshuffle is in the offing. However, with the unimpressive 'Pitru Paksha' period set to begin shortly, followed by Dussehra and Diwali, ministerial changes may take a while yet. But these gubernatorial announcements, including a new ICFI, Janam and Kashmir, could be announced earlier.

Only blind loyalists wanted
Rahul Gandhi's depiction of a person perceived as a defector party reborn a drawback in helping Congress increase its grip. The latest attack for the party in Goa, where assembly elections are due early next year. The Congress must not give an opportunity to the popular Goa Congress Party leader, Vijai Sardesai, who has represented the Fardesa assembly constituency in South Goa since 2012. Party President Mallikarjun Kharge met Sardesai in May and has been waiting for a word from Rahul to permit him, but without any welcoming word, Sardesai decided to accept Arvind Kejriwal's offer to join AAP, a move which would divide the Opposition vote.

Political party, not bureaucracy
The BJP government appears nervous and on the back foot, but Rahul Gandhi, as Leader of Opposition, has not been able to seize the moment to the extent expected. He, instead of touring and building public opinion, has been bogged down in a time-consuming exercise, selecting junior-level party office-bearers. The procedure is unnecessarily bureaucratic, with candidates shortlisted after getting recommendations from state party in-charges or central office-bearers. The stamp of General Secretary (Organisation) KC Venugopal in most selections is obvious.

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